

Shop Sergeant

Membership Meeting Review

Jeff Irland · May 6, 2026 · Makersmiths Leesburg (MSL)

What is the Problem

- MSL has some truly outgoing Volunteers, especially Stewards, the volume of regular tasks needs to be delegated across the shoulders of other Members.
- Constantly reiterating the same needs to volunteers can become a wearisome obligation for Stewards.
- The most immediate tasks get attention, but the routine cleaning, organizing, and maintaining the Shops can suffer.

Initial Steps:

1. Need a MSL volunteer to communicate with the Leesburg Stewards and coordinate a comprehensive to-do list for the Shops, including regular cleaning tasks and preventative maintenance.
2. With assistance of Stewards, establish a thorough checklist for each Shop, on it's own clipboard near the Shop entry, to log volunteer hours and keep an eye on what's not getting done.

Strategic Vision:

1. Remove as much friction as possible from the current process via simplifying, regularizing, and automating.
2. Engage, motivate, and recognize Members contribution by making the process more visible

Shop Sergeant: Why We Need This

MSL's current work task volunteering process has several weaknesses. A new automated process, called Shop Sergeant, is proposed to remove much of the friction in the current process, make work task activity more visible, and gather data to measure our continuing improvement. This new process uses Slack as its primary communication/control medium, but can also be trigger via a few clicks on a mobile phone web form.

Current paper-only process has 5 critical gaps:

Gap	Problem	Impact
Incomplete records	Members rarely write their name and date after completing a task	No reliable record of who did what — member contribution data simply doesn't exist
No cumulative history	Sign-up sheets are discarded when replaced	No historical data to support MSL's 501©(3) volunteer-labor documentation
No steward monitoring	Stewards have no way to see overdue or ignored tasks	Problems surface only when equipment breaks or a safety issue arises — never proactively
No scheduling	Periodic tasks have no mechanism to track whether they were done on time	Maintenance gets forgotten; equipment degrades; safety risks accumulate
No recognition	Top contributors can't be identified because records don't exist	Highly engaged members receive no recognition; motivation and community goodwill suffer

Shop Sergeant: Agentic AI Capabilities

Using Claude for two primary capabilities:

1. Natural Language Query Processing

- Members & Stewards ask questions in plain English:

"What tasks are still open in the metalshop?"
"How many tasks have members done this month?"

- Members ask for information or instructions in plain English:

"Give me instructions on how to clean MSL-METAL-005"
"When was the bandsaw last cleaned?"

- Claude parses the question, constructs the Google Sheets query, and formats an answer, and response back via Slack.

2. Slack Update Task Processing

- Member posts in `#shop-queries` :

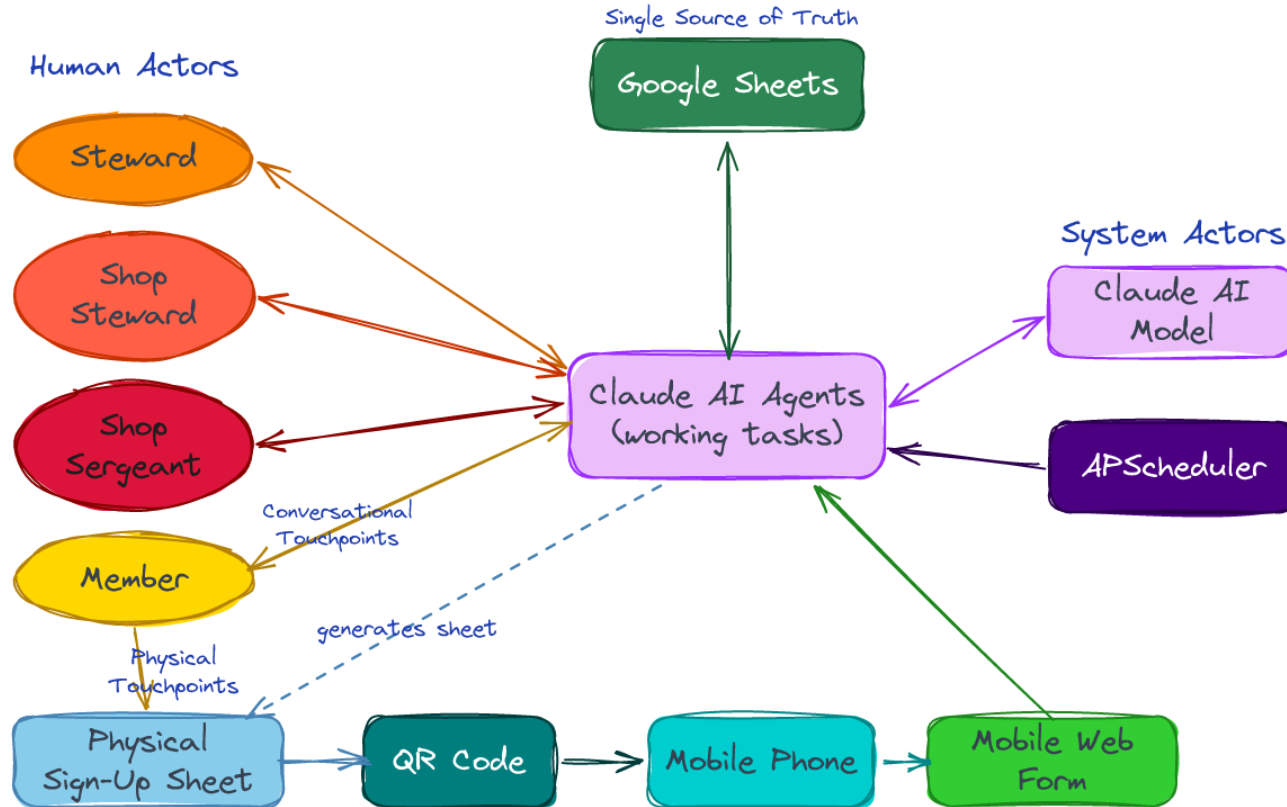
"I just finished cleaning the metalshop floor"
"Wednesday I spent 1 hour fixing the broken front door lock"

- Claude identifies the most likely task, presents it for member confirmation, then writes to Google Sheets.
If no match, offer to ask for approval to make a new task item.

What Claude agents will NOT be allowed to do:

- Modify data without member confirmation
- Execute administrative commands from `#shop-queries`
- Access data or perform tasks outside its targeted function

Pipeline Overview



Task Capture Sign-Up Sheet — Example Output



Location:
Metalshop
Steward: Brad
Hess

Volunteer Opportunities



Task Name	Last Done	Frequency	Member Name / Date	Member Name / Date	Member Name / Date
Dust & Wipe Down Machine Do not use any cleaning solvent. Just a dry or damp cloth should be used. MSL-METAL-001	NA	Weekly			
Clear Off & Organize Tabletops MSL-METAL-002	NA	Daily			
Remove Anything That is Not CNC and Put Away Every CNC / Big Red thing has its place, so place it there. MSL-METAL-003	NA	Daily			
Vaccum Floor MSL-METAL-004	NA	Daily			
Check Dust Collection and Empty if Needed Pull the handle on the left side and remove the basket. Dump its contents in the dumpster in the back of the building. MSL-METAL-005	NA	Weekly			
Empty Shop Vac Dump its contents in the dumpster in the back of the building. MSL-METAL-006	NA	Bi-Weekly			
Empty Saw Dust On the front of the machine, remove the small basket and put in the dumpster. MSL-METAL-007	NA	Bi-Weekly			

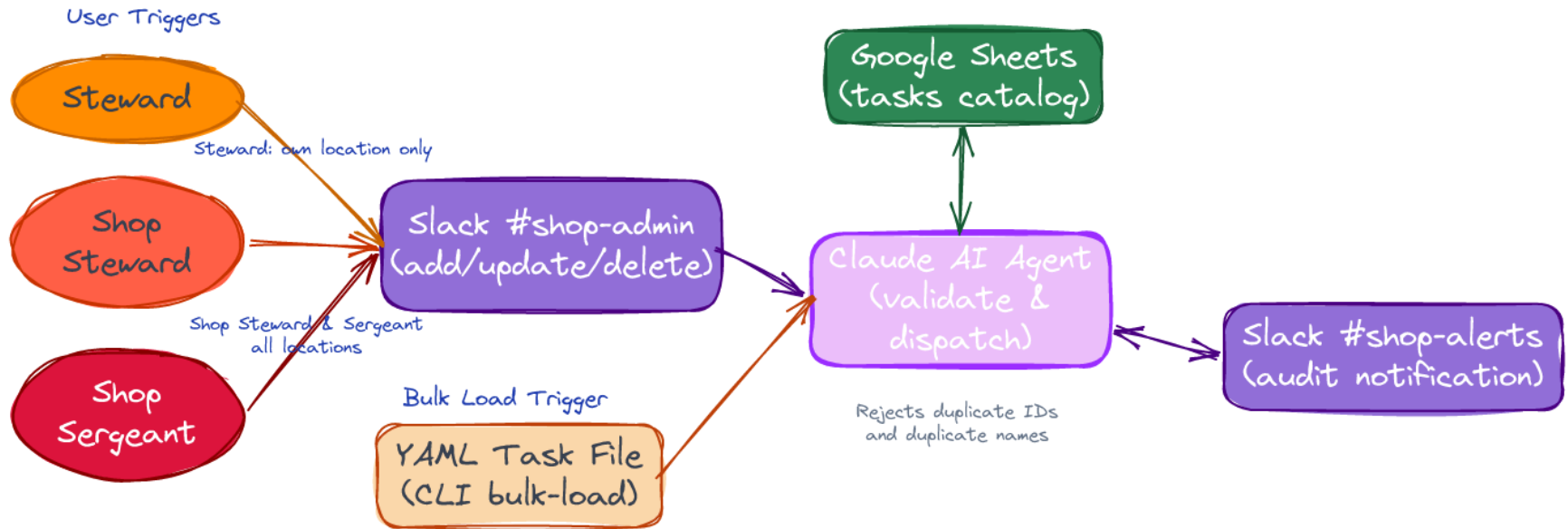
Questions concerning the design & use of this form should be sent to Jeff Irland (xxx)

Metalshop sign-up sheet (v2) — single QR code in header
· 8.5×11" landscape · black-and-white printable

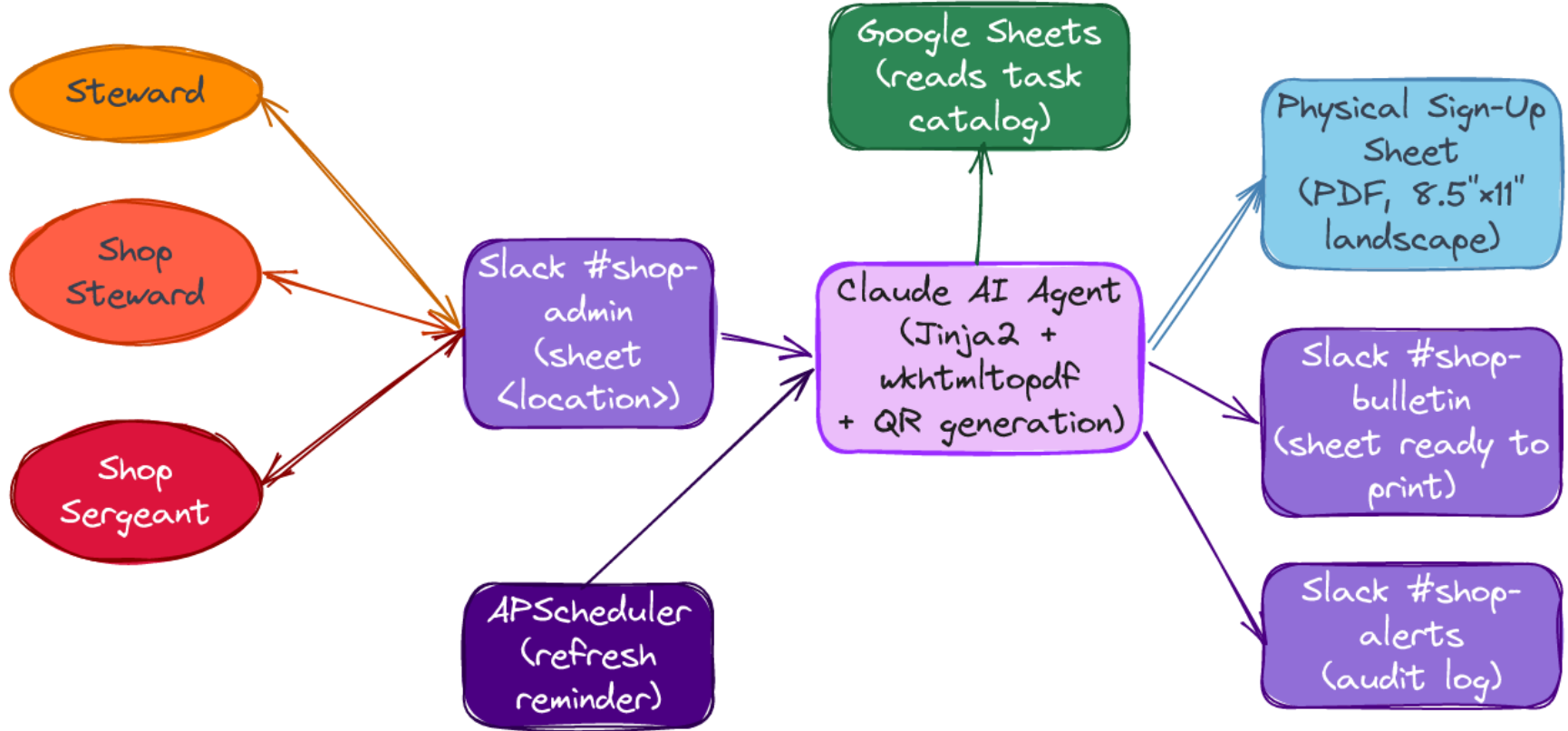
Questions & Discussion

- eMail: jeff.irland@verison.net
- Slack: [jeff.irland](#)
- Source: github.com/jeffskinnerbox/makersmiths-shop
 - Full requirements: [docs/requirements.md](#)
 - Next document: [docs/specifications.md](#)

Task Database Pipeline

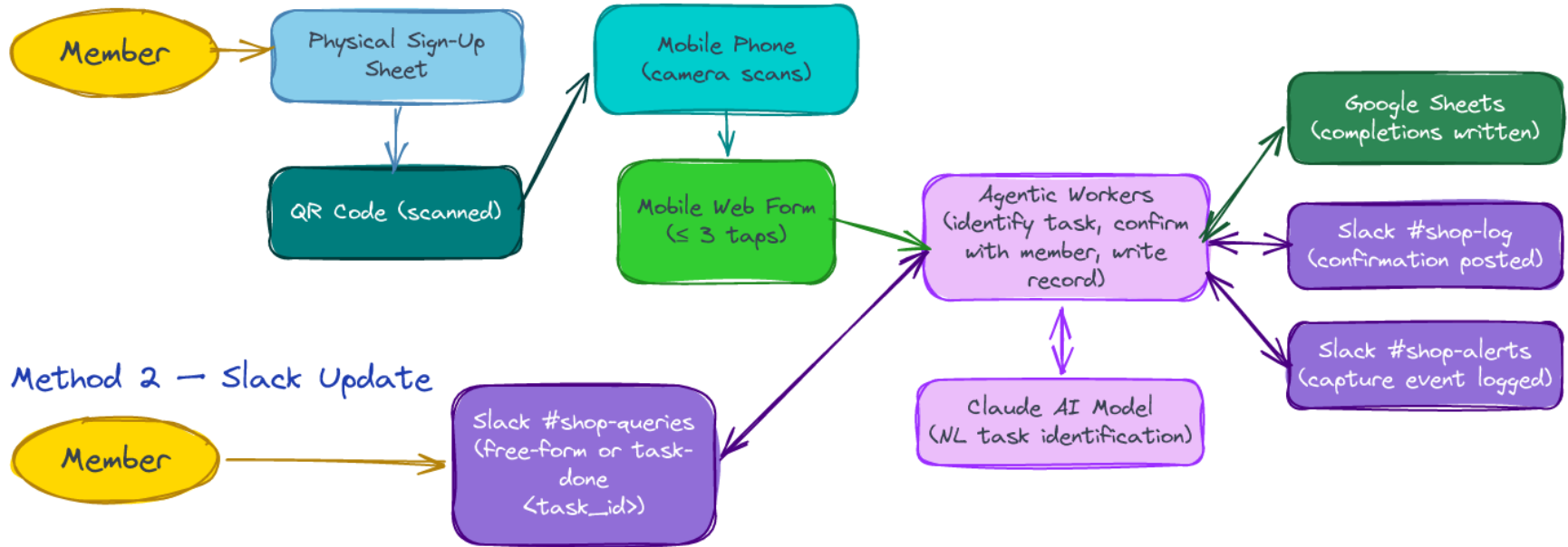


Task Sheet Pipeline



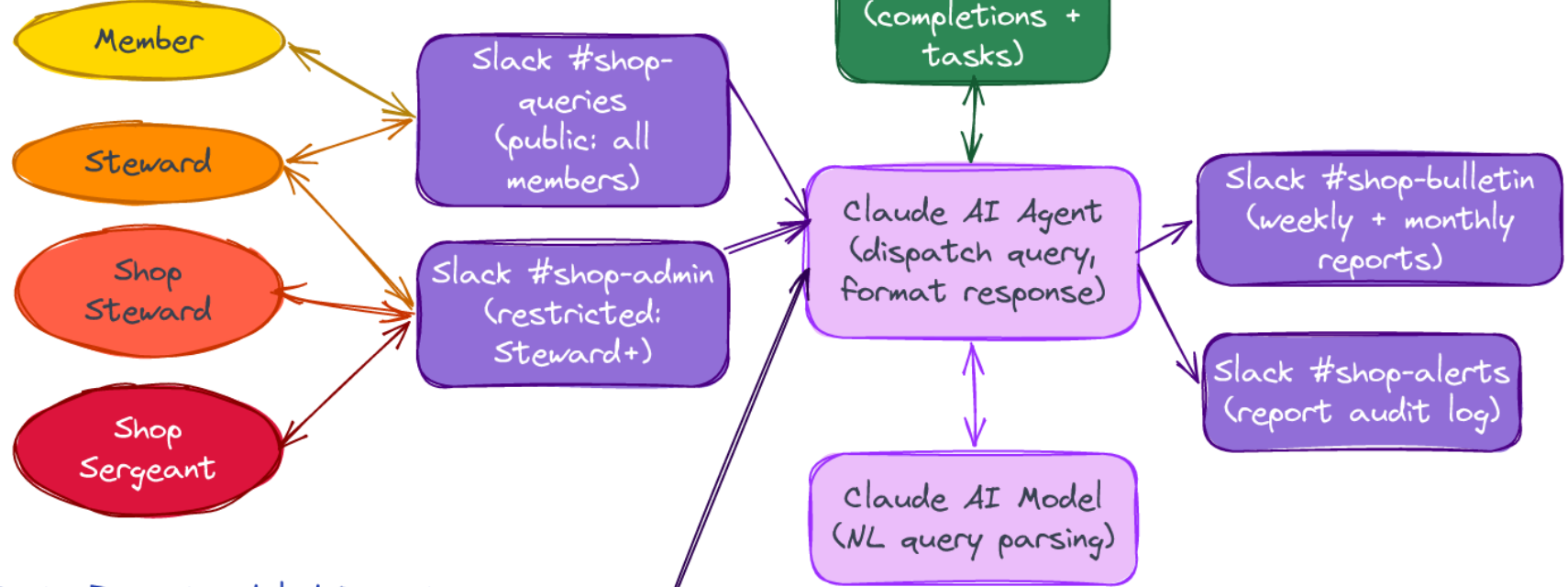
Task Capture Pipeline

Method 1 — Single-Sheet QR



Task Reporting Pipeline

Path A — On-Demand NL Query



Path B — Scheduled Reports

